



Morgan Pike

STEWARD OF THISTLEDOWN HOUSE

“Twenty-five years of polishing the silver, and not one thing missed.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

CORE CHARACTER

ALWAYS IN PLAY

WHAT TO WEAR

A crisp dark jacket or waistcoat, a white shirt, a ring of keys at the belt and a dusting cloth peeping from one pocket.

At the table you are: dignified, observant and a little protective of the house.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

Your story

You have run Thistledown House for twenty-five years. Barty was difficult, generous and fond of routine: a glass of elderflower cordial in the study before supper, every evening without fail. Anyone who has stayed here knows it.

YOUR SECRET

Last spring, while dusting the study, you saw a draft of Barty's will. It leaves you the gate lodge and £500. You have never told a soul. You also poured tonight's glass, so you know eyes will turn to you.

Where you were

5:15 - 5:35	Polishing the hall table. You heard voices from the study.
5:45	Poured Barty's glass in the study.
5:50 - 6:30	In the kitchen with Cook and Dot, the housemaid: soup, then silver.
6:30	Carried the sherry tray to the drawing room.
6:45	Went to say supper was ready. You could not wake Barty, and fetched the doctor.

Your goal tonight

Protect the good name of the house and see the truth come out. Keep the will quiet until Round 3.

If someone asks you...

"Did you pour the cordial?" "I did, at a quarter to six, from a fresh bottle, as I have every evening for twenty-five years."

"Who are Cook and Dot?" "Cook runs the kitchen and Dot is the housemaid. Both were with me all evening."

"Do you gain anything?" Before Round 3: "I lose a household I have served half my life."

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Morgan Pike • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

- SHARE THIS
- **(MUST SHARE)** At a quarter to six I opened a fresh bottle of cordial in the study, poured one glass and set a saucer on top to keep the wasps off. The desk held nothing else but the blotter and the pen tray. Barty said, “Back from the garden by half past six,” and went out through the terrace door.
 - From ten to six I was down in the kitchen with Cook and Dot. Cook keeps a slate of everything.
- ASK
- **Rowan:** “I saw you leave the study at about twenty to six looking upset. What did you and Barty talk about?”
 - **Ellis:** “How was Barty’s heart at five o’clock?”
- YOUR TASK
- Ask each guest how they take their cordial, and note who seems to know Barty’s evening habit best.



FOLD OR CUT HERE • KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

- SHARE THIS
- **(MUST SHARE)** From the hall I heard Barty and Sage in the study from 5:15 to 5:35. Barty’s voice was raised: “Every penny, Sage. By Monday.”
 - After Barty went out to the garden, I did not set foot in the study again until 6:45, when I went to say supper was ready.
- ASK
- **Sage:** “What did Barty mean by ‘every penny, by Monday’?”
 - **Ellis:** “Could the powder have gone into the bottle instead of the glass?”
- YOUR TASK
- Look at Evidence #5 and tell the table exactly what was under that saucer when you set it down at 5:45: nothing at all.

NOTES • ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

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THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- Barty's will leaves me the gate lodge and £500. I saw it by accident last spring. I would give it all back for one more grumpy "good evening."
- Dot lit the library fire at about ten past six and came back saying nobody was in there.

ASK

- **Sage:** “You say you spent that hour in the library. Which papers were you reading, and was the fire lit?”
- **Rowan:** “Did Barty ever mention the Trust accounts to you?”

YOUR TASK

Pour (or mime pouring) a glass for the table and propose a toast: “To Thistledown.”

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

#	NAME	ROLE	#	NAME	ROLE
10	Rowan Thistle	Heir to Thistledown House	14	Harper Vale	Food Critic
11	Ellis Fairweather	Family Doctor	15	Quinn Ashby	Head Gardener
12	Morgan Pike	Steward of Thistledown House	16	Avery Lark	Newspaper Reporter
13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef